Beyond Pull Requests:

How Non-Code Contributions Scale Open-Source Projects

COMMUNITY OVER/CODE

Kris Freedain

Sakshi Nasha

Rich Bowen



OCTOBER 11-14, 2026 *GLASGOW, SCOTLAND*

Who we are (and who's missing)



Kris Freedain (he/him)

Senior Community Manager, OpenSearch project

Rich Bowen (he/him)
VP Community Development, Apache Software Foundation





Sakshi Nasha (she/her)
Software Engineer at Cohesity
OpenSearch Ambassador & Contributor

I want to contribute… but I'm not able to write code

Most open source projects don’t fail because of a lack of code – they struggle because of a lack of community

Don’t just say “Y’all come help.” Create those opportunities.

What REALLY Powers Open Source



1. Feature development
2. Reviews
   RFC discussions
   Samples
   Blogs
3. Questions
   Documentation
   Testing
   Bug reports
   Community support

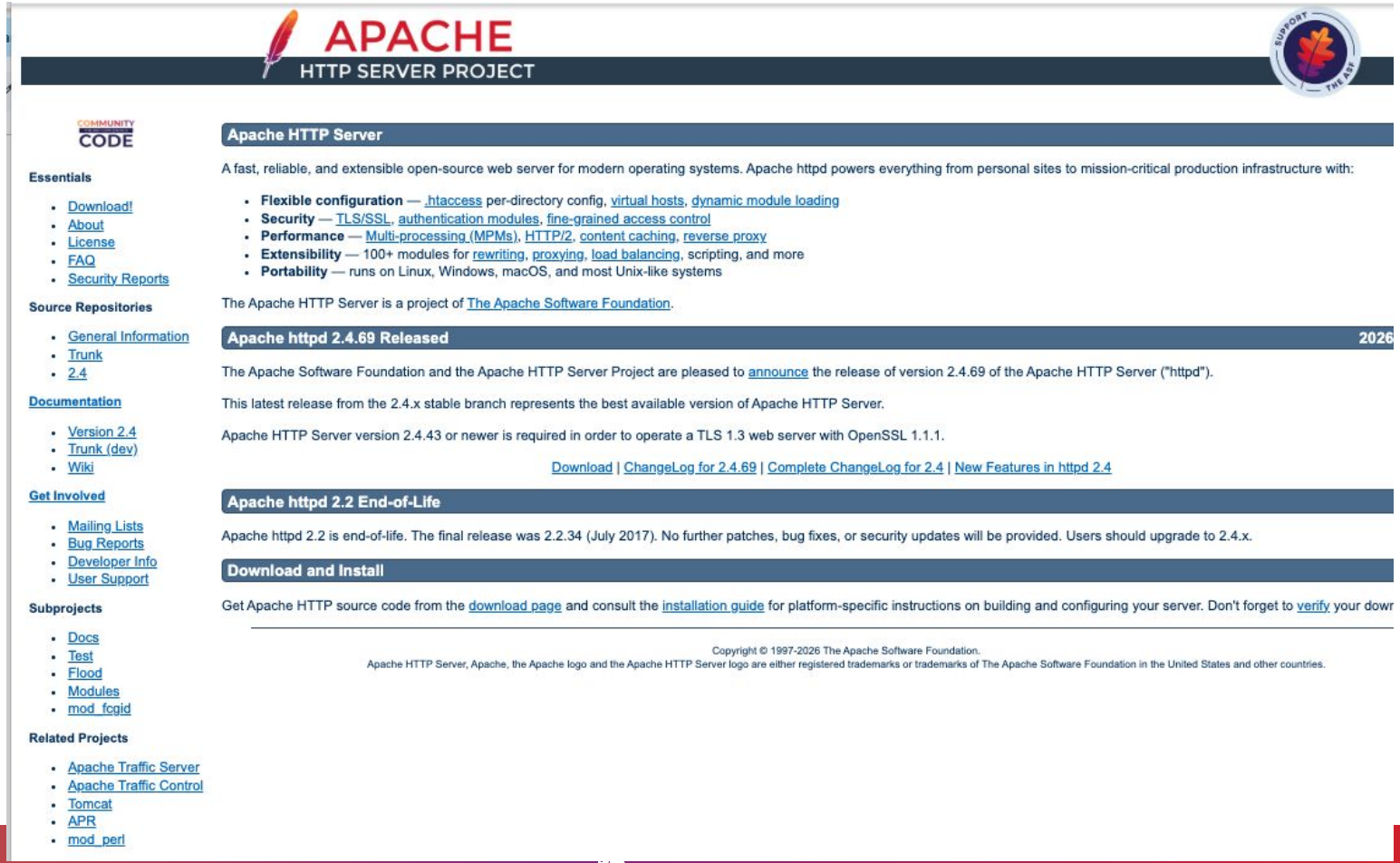
Design & product

- **Product manager** — decides what gets built and why; owns the roadmap and priorities
- **Project / program manager** — tracks what's in flight, coordinates people, keeps releases on schedule
- **Business analyst / requirements analyst** — translates needs into specifications
- **UX designer** — interaction design, user flows, information architecture
- **UI / visual designer** — layout, color, typography, components
- **Graphic / brand designer** — logos, mascots, banners, promotional imagery
- **UX researcher** — user interviews, usability testing, feedback synthesis
- **Accessibility specialist** — ensures the product works for everyone (a11y)

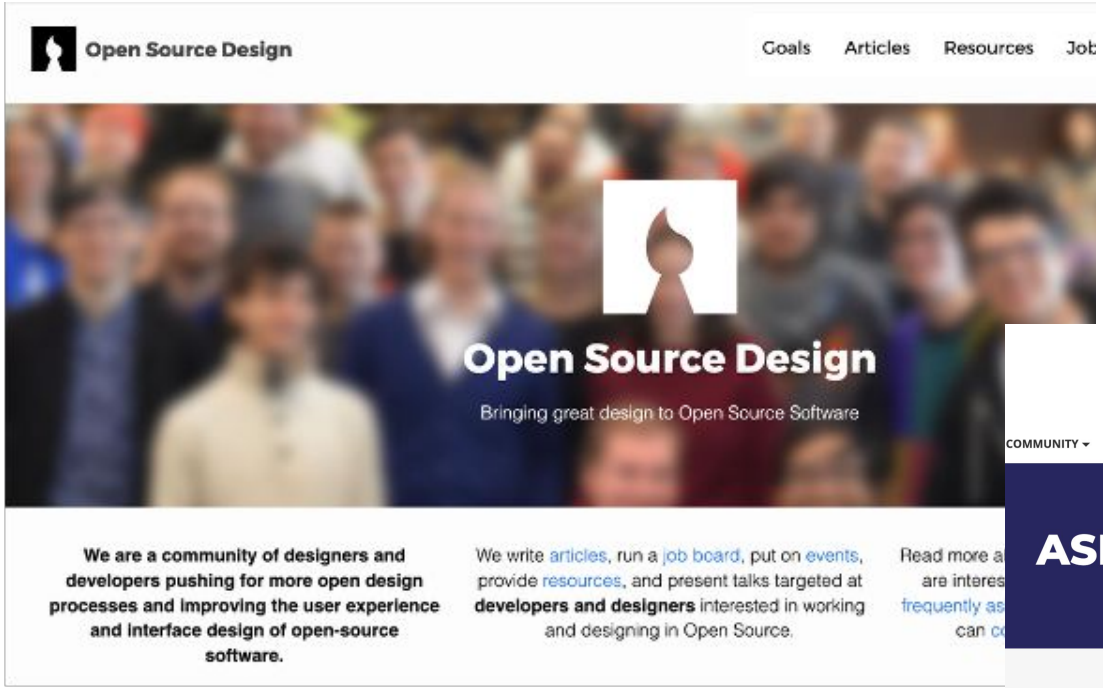
Project Management

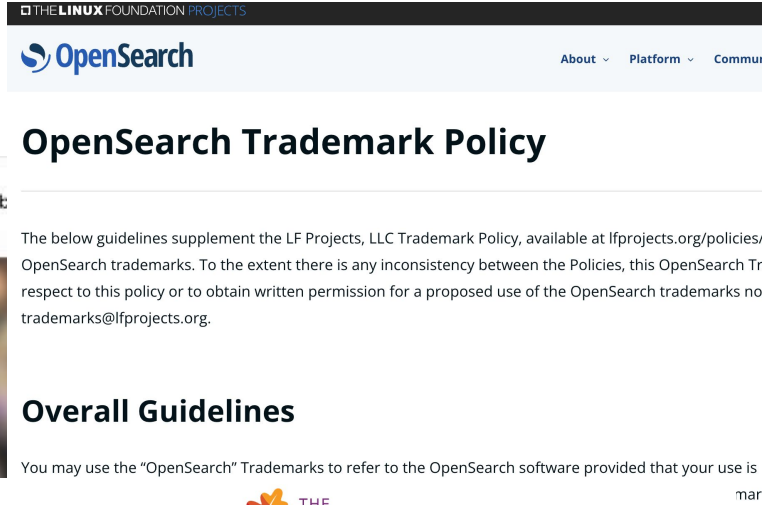
"Anyone can work on anything" doesn't mean that planning is bad

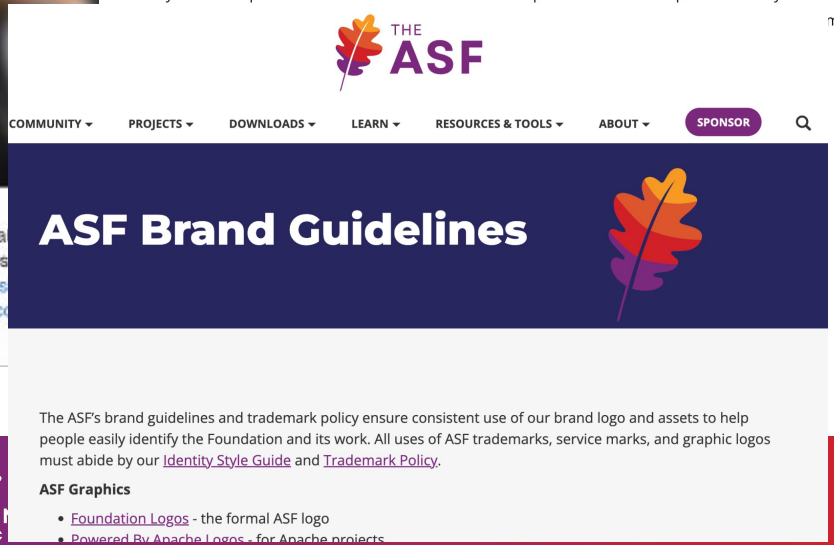
Design


APACHE
HTTP SERVER PROJECT
COMMUNITY CODE
Essentials
Download!
About
License
FAQ
Security Reports
Source Repositories
General Information
Trunk
2.4
Documentation
Version 2.4
Trunk (dev)
Wiki
Get Involved
Mailing Lists
Bug Reports
Developer Info
User Support
Subprojects
Docs
Test
Flood
Modules
mod_fcgid
Related Projects
Apache Traffic Server
Apache Traffic Control
Tomcat
APR
mod_perl
Apache HTTP Server
A fast, reliable, and extensible open-source web server for modern operating systems. Apache httpd powers everything from personal sites to mission-critical production infrastructure with:
Flexible configuration — .htaccess per-directory config, virtual hosts, dynamic module loading
Security — TLS/SSL, authentication modules, fine-grained access control
Performance — Multi-processing (MPMs), HTTP/2, content caching, reverse proxy
Extensibility — 100+ modules for rewriting, proxying, load balancing, scripting, and more
Portability — runs on Linux, Windows, macOS, and most Unix-like systems
The Apache HTTP Server is a project of The Apache Software Foundation.
Apache httpd 2.4.69 Released
2026
The Apache Software Foundation and the Apache HTTP Server Project are pleased to announce the release of version 2.4.69 of the Apache HTTP Server ("httpd").
This latest release from the 2.4.x stable branch represents the best available version of Apache HTTP Server.
Apache HTTP Server version 2.4.43 or newer is required in order to operate a TLS 1.3 web server with OpenSSL 1.1.1.
Download | ChangeLog for 2.4.69 | Complete ChangeLog for 2.4 | New Features in httpd 2.4
Apache httpd 2.2 End-of-Life
Apache httpd 2.2 is end-of-life. The final release was 2.2.34 (July 2017). No further patches, bug fixes, or security updates will be provided. Users should upgrade to 2.4.x.
Download and Install
Get Apache HTTP source code from the download page and consult the installation guide for platform-specific instructions on building and configuring your server. Don't forget to verify your dowr
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Apache HTTP Server, Apache, the Apache logo and the Apache HTTP Server logo are either registered trademarks or trademarks of The Apache Software Foundation in the United States and other countries.

Design


Open Source Design
Goals
Articles
Resources
Job
Open Source Design
Bringing great design to Open Source Software
We are a community of designers and developers pushing for more open design processes and improving the user experience and interface design of open-source software.
We write articles, run a job board, put on events, provide resources, and present talks targeted at developers and designers interested in working and designing in Open Source.
Read more a
are interes
frequently as
can c


THE LINUX FOUNDATION PROJECTS
OpenSearch
About
Platform
Commu
OpenSearch Trademark Policy
The below guidelines supplement the LF Projects, LLC Trademark Policy, available at lfprojects.org/policies/
OpenSearch trademarks. To the extent there is any inconsistency between the Policies, this OpenSearch Tr
respect to this policy or to obtain written permission for a proposed use of the OpenSearch trademarks no
trademarks@lfprojects.org.
Overall Guidelines
You may use the "OpenSearch" Trademarks to refer to the OpenSearch software provided that your use is
mar


THE ASF
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RESOURCES & TOOLS
ABOUT
SPONSOR
ASF Brand Guidelines
The ASF's brand guidelines and trademark policy ensure consistent use of our brand logo and assets to help people easily identify the Foundation and its work. All uses of ASF trademarks, service marks, and graphic logos must abide by our Identity Style Guide and Trademark Policy.
ASF Graphics
Foundation Logos - the formal ASF logo
Powered By Apache Logos - for Apache projects

Quality & reliability

- **QA / test engineer** — test planning, manual and exploratory testing
- **Release / build manager** — packaging, release candidates, versioning
- **Site reliability / operations (SRE/DevOps)** — deployment, uptime, infrastructure
- **Security specialist** — vulnerability assessment, CVE handling, secure design

Testing

A good test suite encourages contributor confidence that they can make changes without breaking stuff.



Build & Release

README | Code of conduct | Contributing | Apache-2.0 license | Security

OpenSearch | Build

python-tests passing | groovy-tests passing | codecov 97%

- Releasing OpenSearch
  - Releases and Versions
  - Release labels
- Onboarding a New Plugin
- Building and Testing an OpenSearch Distribution
  - Testing the Distribution
  - Signing Artifacts
    - PGP
    - Windows
  - Signing RPM artifacts
- Making a Release
  - Releasing for Linux
  - Releasing for FreeBSD
  - Releasing for Windows

ICEBERG Apache Iceberg™

Search

Home | Quickstart | Docs | Releases | Project | Community | Blog | Specification

Project
Contributing
Multi-engine support
Developer snapshot testing
Benchmarks
Security
How to release

ASF
Sponsorship
Events
Privacy
License
Security
Sponsors

Home > Project

Introduction

This page walks you through the release process of the Iceberg project. Here you can read about the release process in general for an Apache project.

Decisions about releases are made by three groups:

- Release Manager: Does the work of creating the release, signing it, counting votes, announcing the release and so on. Requires the assistance of a committer for some steps.
- The community: Performs the discussion of whether it is the right time to create a release and what that release should contain. The community can also cast non-binding votes on the release.
- PMC: Gives binding votes on the release.

This page describes the procedures that the release manager and voting PMC members take during the release process.

Setup

Content & communication

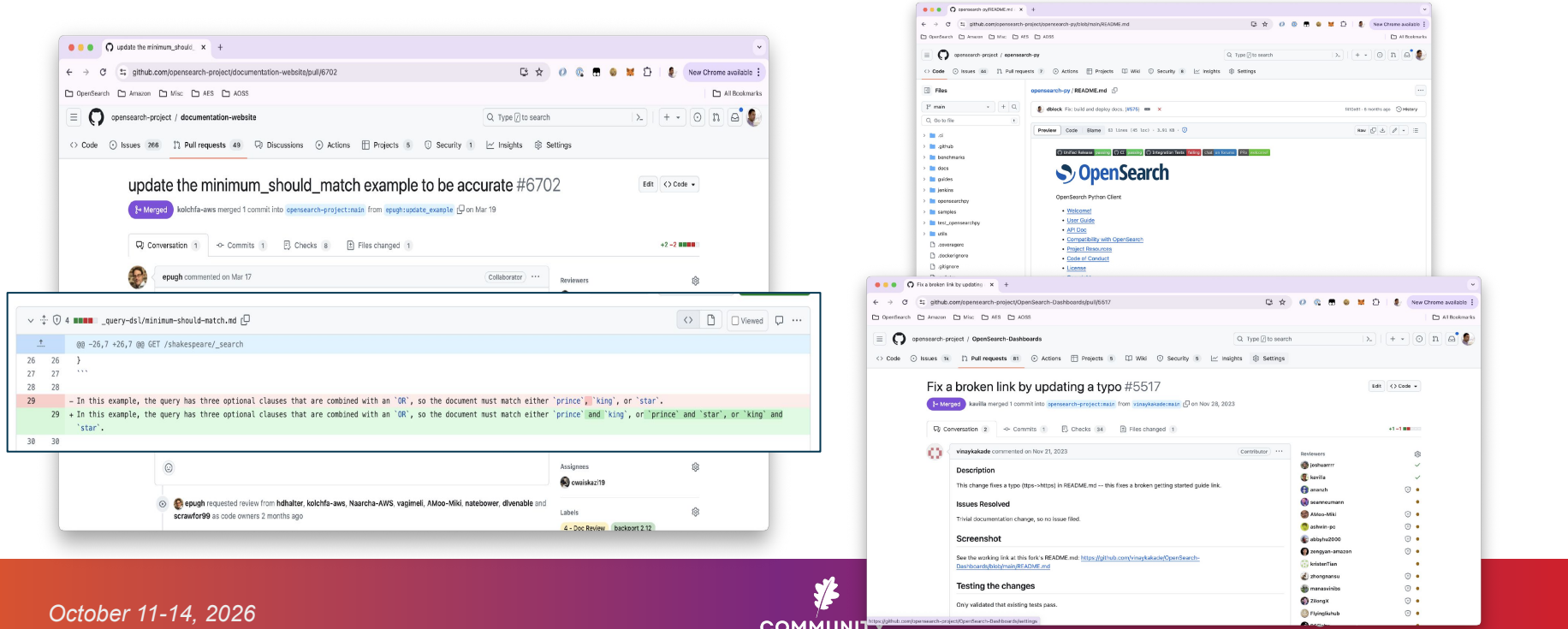
- **Technical writer** — documentation, READMEs, developer guides, API docs
- **Translator / localizer** — makes docs and UI available in other languages
- **Developer advocate / evangelist** — demos, talks, sample projects, community bridge
- **Content writer / blogger** — use-case stories, release announcements
- **Marketing & social media** — promotion, scheduling, contributor milestones
- **Community manager** — onboarding, welcoming, mailing-list and forum stewardship

The Documentation Is wrong

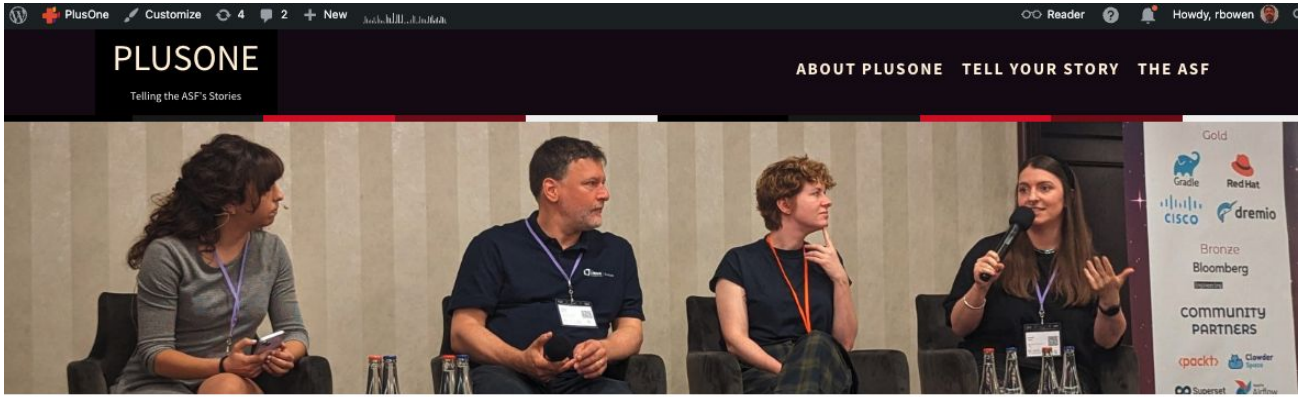
- Read the docs. Tell us what's broken
- Your first contribution doesn't need to be a correction - it can be pointing out something that just doesn't work

Small Contributions → Big Impact

Documentation, README.md, DEVELOPER_GUIDE.md & more



Marketing and Promotion



PLUSONE: APACHE BUILDSTREAM

September 15, 2026
rbowen

PlusOne: Apache BuildStream — with Sam Thursfield



Apache BuildStream is a software integration tool that orchestrates the building of entire Linux operating systems from source — assembling hundreds of components, each with its own build system and programming language, into reproducible outputs. Sam Thursfield from Codethink joins the show to explain how BuildStream differs from tools like Bazel, Nix, and traditional distro package managers, how it grew out of an R&D project to become the build engine behind GNOME OS and the Freedesktop SDK Flatpak runtime, and why the project chose the Apache Software Foundation as its long-term home. We also talk about the relationship with BuildGrid, the Bloomberg connection, the plugin architecture that keeps the core stable, and where new contributors can get involved.

00:00 00:00

Learn more: https://buildstream.apache.org
Freedesktop SDK: https://freedesktop-sdk.io

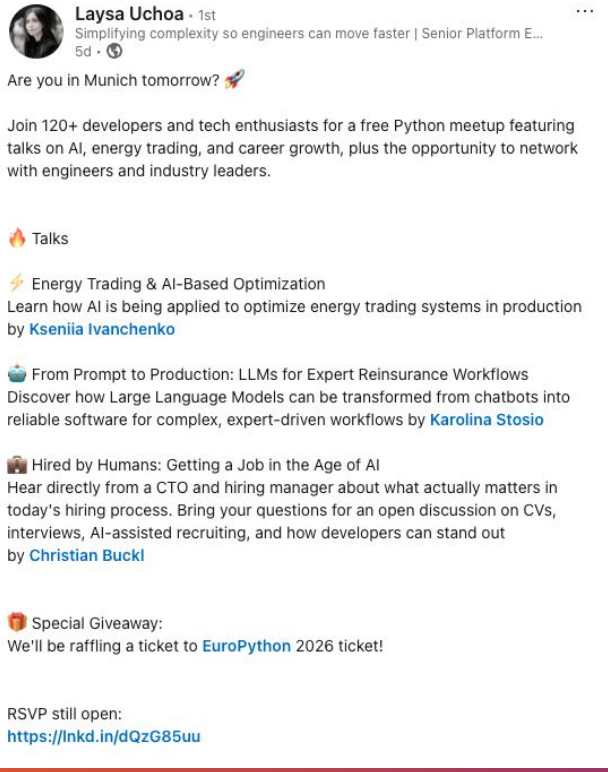
RECENT POSTS

अनुवाद और स्थानीयकरण

- (Translation and localization)

Small Contributions → Big Impact

Social media and sharing with your community



Laysa Uchoa · 1st
Simplifying complexity so engineers can move faster | Senior Platform E...
5d ·

Are you in Munich tomorrow? 🚀

Join 120+ developers and tech enthusiasts for a free Python meetup featuring talks on AI, energy trading, and career growth, plus the opportunity to network with engineers and industry leaders.

🔥 Talks

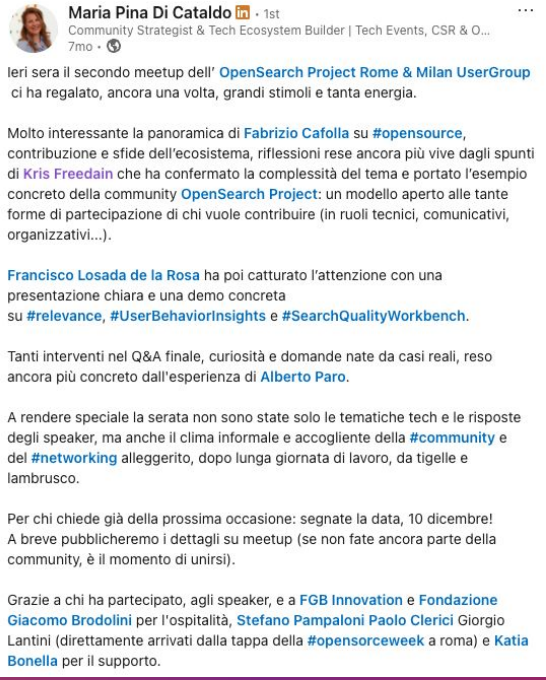
⚡ Energy Trading & AI-Based Optimization
Learn how AI is being applied to optimize energy trading systems in production by Kseniia Ivanchenko

🤖 From Prompt to Production: LLMs for Expert Reinsurance Workflows
Discover how Large Language Models can be transformed from chatbots into reliable software for complex, expert-driven workflows by Karolina Stosio

💼 Hired by Humans: Getting a Job in the Age of AI
Hear directly from a CTO and hiring manager about what actually matters in today's hiring process. Bring your questions for an open discussion on CVs, interviews, AI-assisted recruiting, and how developers can stand out by Christian Buckl

🎁 Special Giveaway:
We'll be raffling a ticket to EuroPython 2026 ticket!

RSVP still open:
https://lnkd.in/dQzG85uu



Maria Pina Di Cataldo · 1st
Community Strategist & Tech Ecosystem Builder | Tech Events, CSR & O...
7mo ·

Ieri sera il secondo meetup dell' OpenSearch Project Rome & Milan UserGroup ci ha regalato, ancora una volta, grandi stimoli e tanta energia.

Molto interessante la panoramica di Fabrizio Cafolla su #opensource, contribuzione e sfide dell'ecosistema, riflessioni rese ancora più vive dagli spunti di Kris Freedain che ha confermato la complessità del tema e portato l'esempio concreto della community OpenSearch Project: un modello aperto alle tante forme di partecipazione di chi vuole contribuire (in ruoli tecnici, comunicativi, organizzativi...).

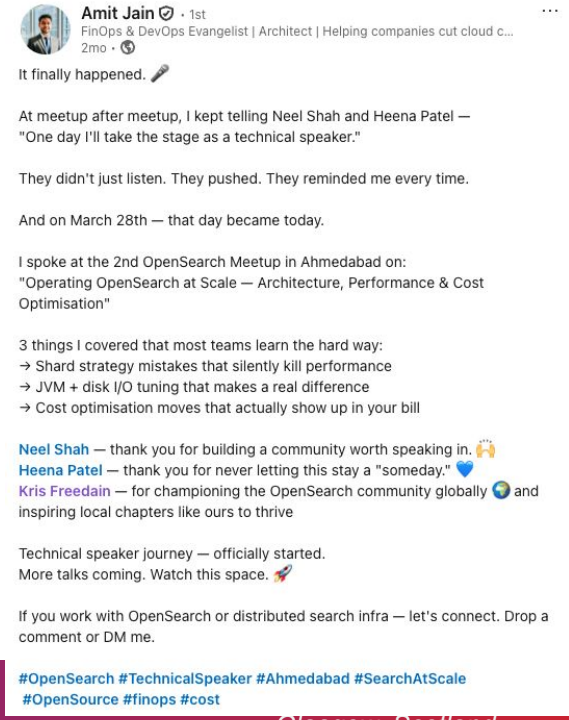
Francisco Losada de la Rosa ha poi catturato l'attenzione con una presentazione chiara e una demo concreta su #relevance, #UserBehaviorInsights e #SearchQualityWorkbench.

Tanti interventi nel Q&A finale, curiosità e domande nate da casi reali, reso ancora più concreto dall'esperienza di Alberto Paro.

A rendere speciale la serata non sono state solo le tematiche tech e le risposte degli speaker, ma anche il clima informale e accogliente della #community e del #networking alleggerito, dopo lunga giornata di lavoro, da tigelle e lambrusco.

Per chi chiede già della prossima occasione: segnate la data, 10 dicembre!
A breve pubblicheremo i dettagli su meetup (se non fate ancora parte della community, è il momento di unirsi).

Grazie a chi ha partecipato, agli speaker, e a FGB Innovation e Fondazione Giacomo Brodolini per l'ospitalità, Stefano Pampaloni Paolo Clerici Giorgio Lantini (direttamente arrivati dalla tappa della #opensorceweek a roma) e Katia Bonella per il supporto.



Amit Jain · 1st
FinOps & DevOps Evangelist | Architect | Helping companies cut cloud c...
2mo ·

It finally happened. 🎤

At meetup after meetup, I kept telling Neel Shah and Heena Patel —
"One day I'll take the stage as a technical speaker."

They didn't just listen. They pushed. They reminded me every time.

And on March 28th — that day became today.

I spoke at the 2nd OpenSearch Meetup in Ahmedabad on:
"Operating OpenSearch at Scale — Architecture, Performance & Cost Optimisation"

3 things I covered that most teams learn the hard way:
→ Shard strategy mistakes that silently kill performance
→ JVM + disk I/O tuning that makes a real difference
→ Cost optimisation moves that actually show up in your bill

Neel Shah — thank you for building a community worth speaking in. 🙌
Heena Patel — thank you for never letting this stay a "someday." 💙
Kris Freedain — for championing the OpenSearch community globally 🌍 and inspiring local chapters like ours to thrive

Technical speaker journey — officially started.
More talks coming. Watch this space. 🚀

If you work with OpenSearch or distributed search infra — let's connect. Drop a comment or DM me.

#OpenSearch #TechnicalSpeaker #Ahmedabad #SearchAtScale #OpenSource #finops #cost

Enhance where you can



Community & governance

- **Event organizer** — meetups, conferences, hackathons, user groups
- **Mentor / onboarding guide** — helps new contributors land their first contribution
- **Moderator** — keeps forums, chat, and mailing lists healthy
- **Governance / PMC member** — project oversight and decision-making
- **Legal / licensing / trademark** — compliance, CLAs, IP
- **Finance / accounting** — budgets, sponsorship, fiscal sponsorship
- **Public policy / standards liaison** — represents the project in broader bodies

Events

Volunteer Opportunities

The Apache Software Foundation events program relies on volunteers to help make our events successful and or want to take on a larger role, there are many ways to contribute.

We welcome volunteers of all experience levels and backgrounds! You do not need to be an Apache member, Apache project to volunteer for these task.

Join the **#volunteers** channel on the apachecon.slack.com Slack instance to connect with other volunteers and

Volunteer Categories

We have volunteer opportunities in several areas. (This is not an exhaustive list. If there's something you see th about it.)

- Hackathon Coordination - Help organize and run hackathons at Apache events
- University Outreach - Connect with colleges and universities across multiple departments
- Meetup Outreach - Engage with local meetup groups about upcoming events
- Speaker Support - Provide coaching and feedback to speakers
- Design - Create visual materials for events and outreach

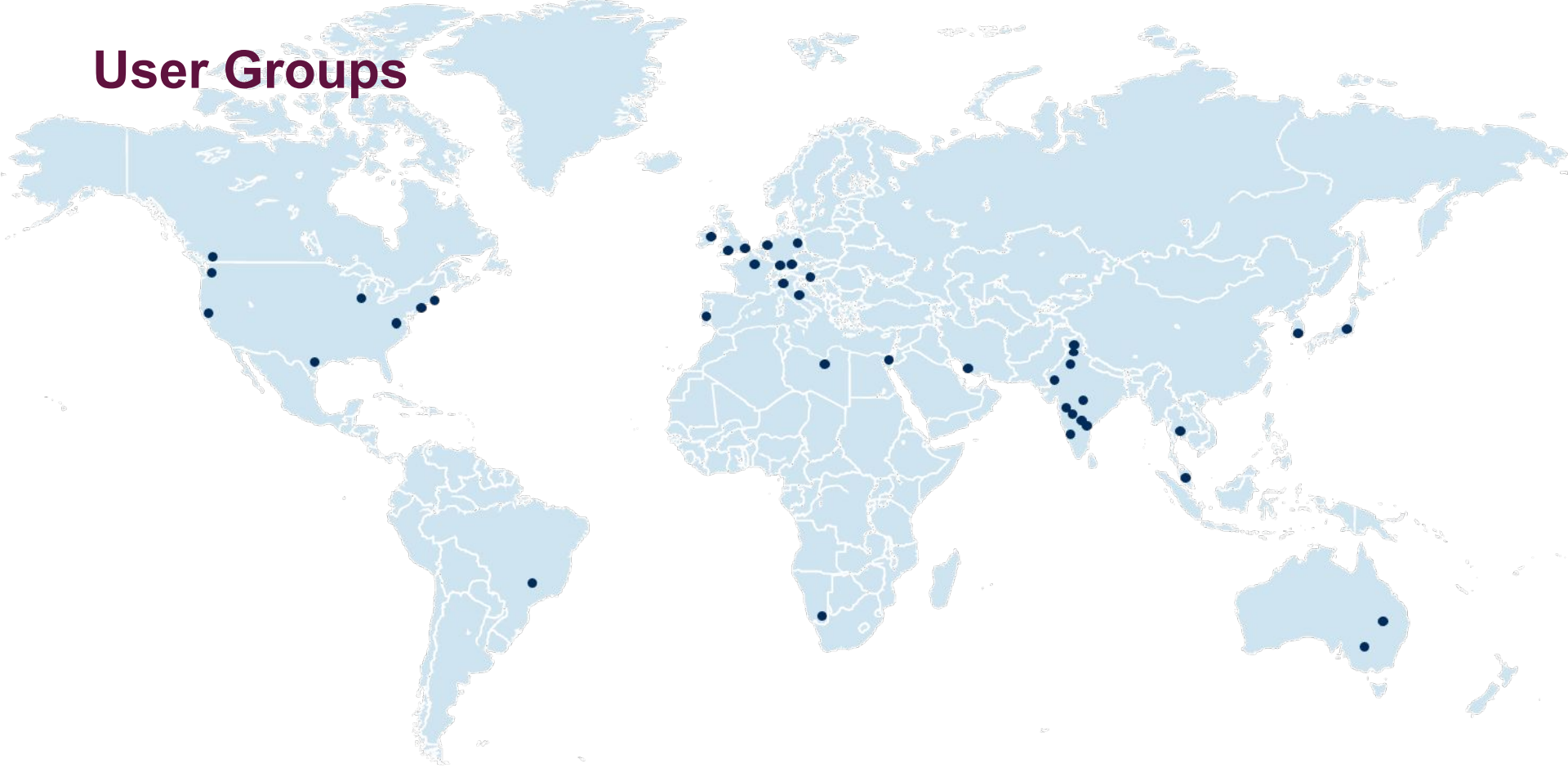
All volunteers work under the ASF Code of Conduct.

Getting Started

To get involved:

1. Join the **#volunteers** channel on apachecon.slack.com
2. Review the specific volunteer opportunities listed above
3. Reach out on the relevant channel or contact the Event Planning mailing list

User Groups





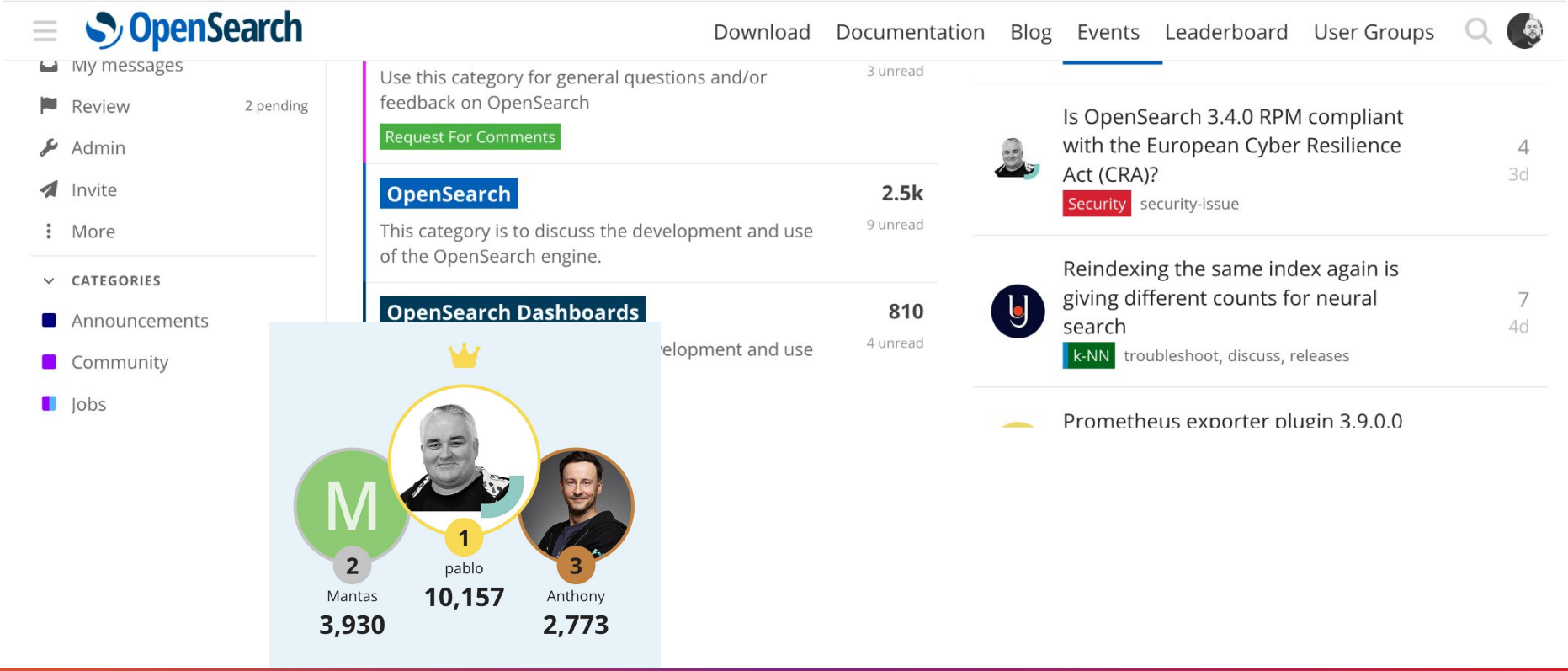
APACHE LOCAL COMMUNITY

s.apache.org/alc

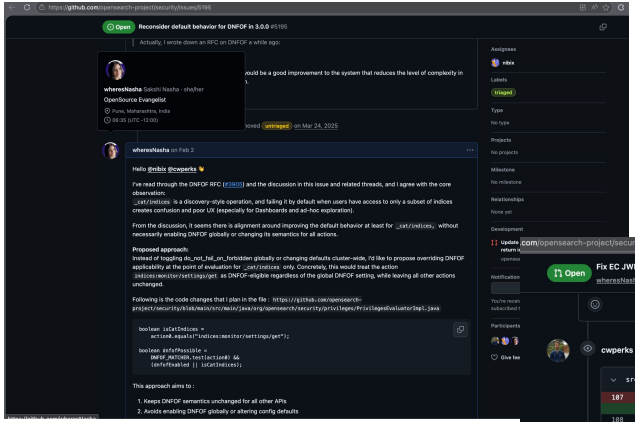
Support & data

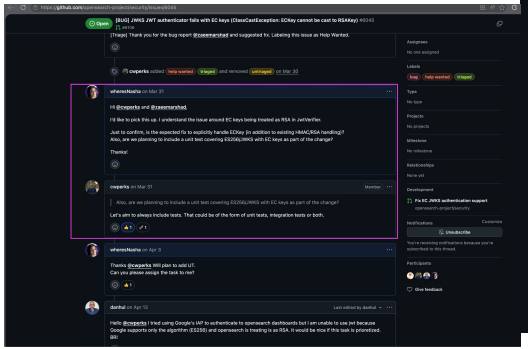
- **User support** — answering questions, triaging issues
- **Bug triager** — reproducing, labeling, routing incoming reports
- **Data / analytics** — usage metrics, contributor and health dashboards
- **Trainer / educator** — courses, workshops, certification material

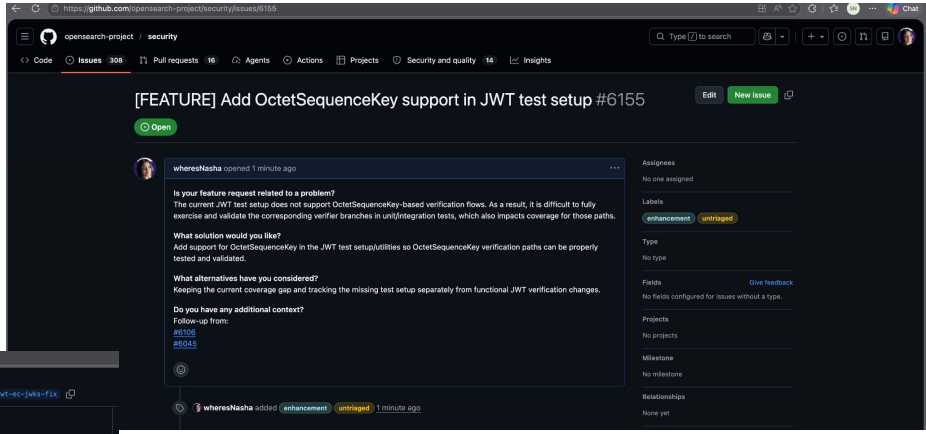
Forum & Support

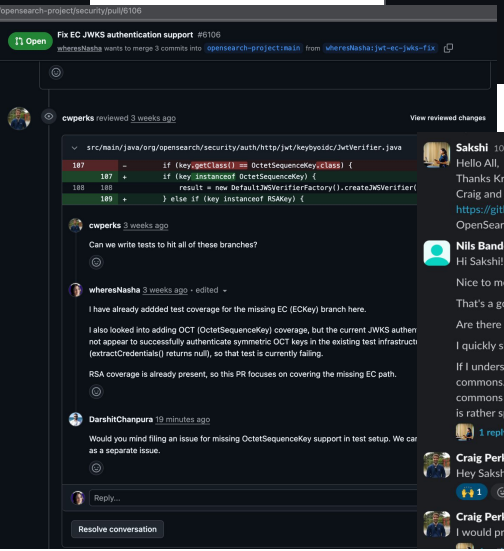


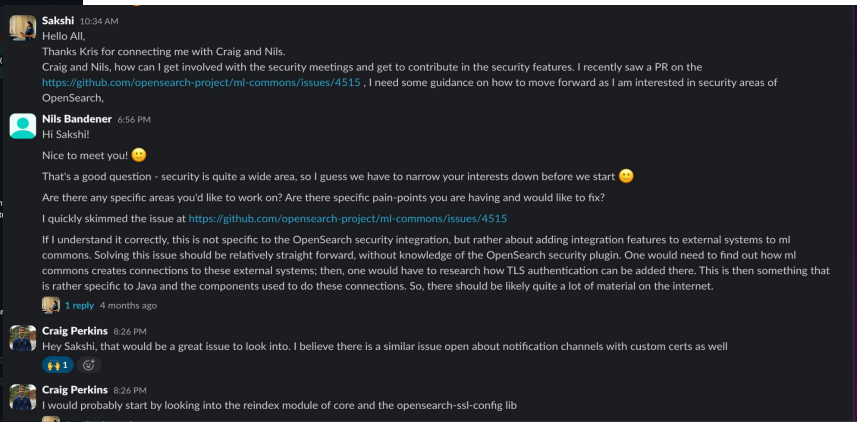
Mentors can help



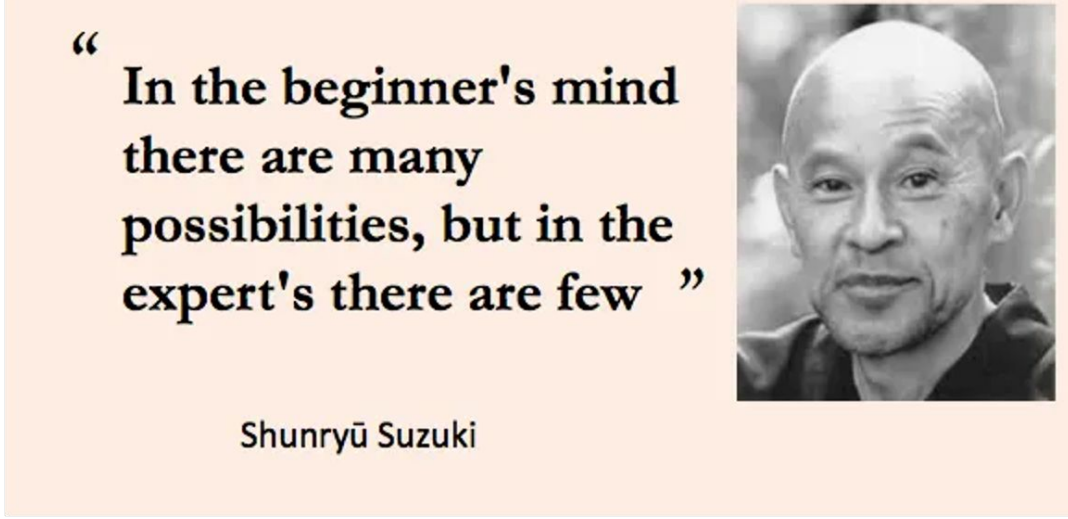








初心



Shoshin - The Beginner’s Mind

Software should solve problems

Ask users what problems the software is not solving

A word about AI

Because it wouldn’t be a tech conference presentation without talking about AI, right?

Come for the code;
Stay for the community

Belonging

Open source works best when participants feel ownership, rather than that they are a visitor in someone else's home.

THANK YOU

rbowen@apache.org

kris@freedain.com

COMMUNITY OVER/CODE GLASGOW 2026

← Slides here